
Task 2

Read the text below. For questions (6—10) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

GROWING UP UNHAPPY?

In recent years evidence has been collected which suggests that the proportion of British children and teenagers who are unhappy is higher than in many other developed countries. For example, a recently published report set out to measure «well-being» among young people in nineteen European countries, plus the United States and Canada, and found that the United Kingdom came bottom.

The report was based on official statistics and surveys in which young people answered questions on a wide range of subjects. With regard to «material well-being» it concluded that when comparing developed countries, there is no clear relationship between GDP (gross domestic product) per head and happiness, but that economic inequality within those countries is linked with unhappiness. The United Kingdom is a relatively unequal country with a relatively high proportion of children and teenagers living in households with less than half the national average income, and this seems to have a negative effect on how they feel about themselves.

Young British people also seem to have less healthy family and peer relationships. The report found that relatively few British fifteen-year-olds sit down with their parents to regularly share the main meal of the day — an event seen by the researchers as an indicator of family togetherness. More worrying was the fact that fewer than half of British eleven-, thirteen- and fifteen-year-olds said they generally found their peers «kind and helpful» (compared with more than 70 % in most of the countries near the top of the well-being table) and that almost 40 % said they had been bullied by other young people in the previous two months. As for «risk behaviours», the report suggested that in Britain a higher proportion of fifteen-year-olds have been drunk on alcohol, smoked cigarettes and taken illegal drugs than in most other developed countries.

More recently, another study has produced similar findings, concluding that young people's lives in Britain have become «more difficult than in the past» and that more of them are «anxious and troubled». This report blames factors such as family breakdown, too much competition in education, income inequality, and even the construction of houses and other buildings in open spaces where children used to play. Its authors also argued that what lies behind most of these things, directly or indirectly, is an individualistic society in which adults are too concerned with their own objectives and insufficiently concerned with looking after others, including children.

- 6 How many countries are featured in the first report?
 - A Nineteen.
 - B Twenty.
 - C Twenty-one.
 - D Twenty-three.
- 7 The first report showed that young people in the richest developed countries _____ in other developed countries.
 - A were less happy than their peers
 - B were much happier than their peers
 - C were as happy as their peers
 - D were a great deal happier than their peers
- 8 Fewer than half of British children found their companions _____.
 - A willing to help.
 - B good and loyal.
 - C handy and friendly.
 - D friendly and honest.
- 9 The second report concluded that the lives of young people in Britain used to be _____.
 - A more difficult.
 - B much poorer.
 - C easier.
 - D more interesting.
- 10 The second report suggests British society is too _____.
 - A unique.
 - B typical.
 - C distinguishing.
 - D egocentric.

Task 3

Read the text below. Match choices (A—H) to (11—16). There are two choices you do not need to use. Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

BODIES UNDER CONSTRUCTION: TEEN COSMETIC SURGERY

Three years ago, when a 15-year-old British girl decided to get breast implants for her sixteenth birthday, the story made headlines around the world. Since then, media reports have continued to speculate that cosmetic surgery, once the exclusive domain of wealthy older women, is a trendy new option for any teenager with an adolescent hang-up.

- 11 Dr Darrick Antell, a top New York City plastic surgeon, says he has seen an increase in the number of teenage patients but cautions against calling it a trend. «One of the main reasons for the increase is visibility: today's teenagers are growing up with parents who have had cosmetic surgery, so they see and hear about it more. The media has also done a good job of making people aware of the procedures available. Another reason is acceptability. In a way, plastic surgery has come out of the closet», Dr Antell says.
- 12 When details of cosmetic procedures are frequently discussed on talk shows and published in magazines, it's not surprising that they filter into our consciousness. «Sometimes when I'm out to dinner with my friends, we'll play a game called *What would you have done?* where we discuss what we would do if money was no object and the procedures were safe», says 18-year-old Alison Preiss. «I could grow up to realize that there are more important things than my nose, or it could really bother me to the point where I decide to have surgery. I suppose it depends on my lifestyle and career choices», says Preiss.
Suzanne Ma, a 19-year-old student, has considered a double eyelid procedure popular in Asia. «I'm Chinese, and I don't like my eyes. I don't have double eyelids, so I feel that my eyes look a lot smaller than they really are. My concerns are not entirely for cosmetic reasons. With my heavy eyelids, my eyelashes don't grow out properly. Some of them get trapped under the eyelids and it's very easy for me to get an infection», Ma says.
- 13 As in North America, plastic surgery is booming overseas, especially in wealthier Asian countries like Taiwan and Korea, where it is seen as a way to improve career prospects and self-confidence. In China, women and some men are paying thousands of dollars to have a brutal surgical procedure performed that lengthens their legs so they can fulfill height requirements often used to narrow down the number of job applicants.
- 14 Cosmetic surgery may have a positive impact if your body image is consistently tied to a negative focus on a particular facial feature or body part. Dr Antell says, «The classic case is a teenage patient of mine who had reconstructive surgery to correct a significant discrepancy between her upper and lower jaws. When she came into my office for the initial consultation she was constantly looking at the floor. After the surgery, she was looking up and smiling. Now she's singing in her local school group».
Dr Antell is careful to point out that there are murky areas. «Liposuction is one of those areas. So is breast augmentation because you're not really sure that the teenager has stopped growing yet. But there are exceptions, for example, if a patient has breast asymmetry».
- 15 Doctors are very aware of the psychological drama affecting our lives and it has become a very important factor when evaluating a patient. Dr Brown says, «The key thing from my perspective is to assess physical, emotional and psychological maturity before treating a patient. I spend a great deal of time with my patients, regardless of their age, to determine that they have thought out their concern carefully and have reasonable goals and expectations». In other words, cosmetic surgery can improve a patient's body but it won't necessarily improve their self-image or guarantee happiness. Dr Antell says, «I've done liposuction on a Sports Illustrated swimsuit model. This is somebody most people would think looked perfect. But she was very insecure. She didn't see herself the way others did. I can't give people confidence».

- 16 Dr Ratusny says, «Teens need to be really realistic with the fact that cosmetic surgery may be only one piece of many things that serve to improve aspects of themselves. There may be physical changes but the real change begins with who they are inside». So, if you're considering cosmetic surgery you need to ask yourself what you hope to achieve because it's not going to be the one magic solution that makes everything better. In fact, it may even change you for the worse — just surf the Web and read the thousands of horror stories from people hoping to find peace of mind or happiness by going under the knife.

This paragraph discusses _____

- A negative effects of reconstructive surgery.
- B major motives of teens cosmetic surgery.
- C physical changes.
- D thinking about the results.
- E personal opinions on the body construction process.
- F being realistic about your own selves.
- G real change of self-esteem.
- H worldwide growing popularity.

Task 4

~~Read the text below. Choose from (A – H) the one which best fits each space (17 – 22). There are two choices you do not need to use. Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.~~

~~BRAIN CELLS TAKE A BREAK~~

~~Scientists have long wanted to know what happens inside the human brain when deep asleep. You may be unconscious, but your brain cells are busy with activity. Neurons, brain cells that conduct electricity, keep your mind humming even while your body is resting.~~

~~In a new study, a team of scientists found that neurons take breaks periodically as a person heads into deep sleep. These pauses in neuron activity help keep people asleep, (17) _____. Sydney Cash, a neurologist at Massachusetts General Hospital and Harvard Medical School in Boston, and his team found a way to study electricity in the brain, inside and out.~~

~~Scientists use different tools to study electrical currents in the brain. One of the most useful is the EEG, or electroencephalogram. An EEG represents the brain's activity as a graph that looks like a long series of differently shaped waves. The height, width and closeness of those waves give scientists a peek at what's happening in a person's head. Even though they can study the patterns, (18) _____.~~

~~In the study led by Cash, the researchers were interested in a particular type of EEG squiggle called a K-complex. To people who don't understand EEG patterns, a K-complex just looks like a squiggle that's larger than the lines around it. To a trained scientist, a K-complex shows a significant change in the electrical activity in the brain.~~

~~A K-complex may show up on an EEG when the sleeping person hears a noise or has his or her sleep disturbed. Or these squiggles may be caused by other reasons.~~

~~EEGs can't see everything, however. They only measure electric signals — including K-complexes — on the outside of the brain. In the new study, the scientists found a way to see even deeper into the brain. They studied patients with epilepsy, (19) _____. Epilepsy is believed to be caused by overactive neurons.~~

~~In previous surgeries, the people with epilepsy had had tiny electrodes implanted deeper inside their brains. Electrodes are also used to study electrical currents, and doctors had hoped (20) _____.~~

~~Cash, who studies epilepsy, realised that those same electrodes could be used to study electrical activity deeper inside the brain while at the same time an EEG told the scientists what was happening on the surface. By comparing the two sets of information, (21) _____.~~

Task 5

Read the text below. For questions (23—32) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

KIDS CAN LOWER THEIR FLU RISK

The flu is in the news. As the flu spreads, healthcare workers have two simple (23) _____ of advice for kids and others who want to prevent the spread of flu germs.

Wash your hands. Viruses don't pass (24) _____ the skin, but they can live on the hands and enter the body when people touch their mouths, eyes, or noses. That's why hand-washing with soap and water is more (25) _____ than anything else in fighting the spread of the flu virus. How long should you wash your hands? Doctors say you should wash for (26) _____ it takes you to say the alphabet from A to Z. That should be long (27) _____ to kill most of germs.

Cover your coughs and sneezes. Most flu germs are (28) _____ through the air. The flu virus clings to droplets that come (29) _____ your mouth when you cough or sneeze. Those wet droplets are pretty heavy, so they don't travel far; they fall quickly to the ground. You can (30) _____ people within a few feet of you from cough or sneeze germs by (31) _____ your mouth and nose with a tissue, your hand, or your shirtsleeve.

Doctors say new flu viruses appear (32) _____ every year. Flu vaccines can prevent the spread of some flu viruses, but they are not effective in fighting all the new flu viruses that might appear. Making a vaccine to fight new viruses can take up to six months. That's why doctors say people can best fight the spread of flu by washing their hands and covering their coughs.

	A	B	C	D
23	lumps	bits	pieces	shares
24	into	over	inside	through
25	effective	operative	persuasive	impressive
26	during	as long as	while	for
27	very	too	enough	much
28	passed	transmitted	gone	sent
29	from	out	with	out of
30	save	rescue	secure	protect
31	shutting	covering	closing	putting
32	nearly	around	almost	just about

Task 6

Read the texts below. For questions (33—42) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

FOUNTAIN PEN MAKES A COMEBACK IN SCOTLAND

Students at one elementary school in Scotland are learning to write in an old-fashioned way. They (33) _____ to write using fountain pens. They use fountain pens to do much of their schoolwork.

When your parents were in school, they probably (34) _____ a few hours each week learning to write (35) _____. But some teachers say there is little time to teach *cursive* handwriting today. They must spend more time teaching (36) _____ and maths and getting students ready for tests. Besides, many students use computers to do their class work and homework. They don't write letters; they send e-mails instead.

Students who learn *cursive* can write (37) _____ than those who print. They do a better job of getting their ideas on paper too. They write more, and students who write more also write better. Kids with good handwriting often feel proud of themselves too.

	A	B	C	D
33	were being taught	are being taught	have been taught	were taught
34	had spent	spent	were spending	had been spending
35	neat	neatness	neatly	neaten
36	to read	read	will read	reading
37	fast	fastest	the fastest	faster

CARTS GIVE MOBILITY TO DISABLED DOGS

Sometimes animals have disabilities that prevent them from walking. A new (38) _____ — a cart with wheels — has given back mobility to some of those animals.

Three of those carts are being used to help three special Chihuahua puppies (39) _____. The puppies — Venus, Carmen, and Pablo — were born last spring without front legs. But now they have been fitted at a New York animal shelter with (40) _____ carts. Straps hold the carts in place on the puppies' bodies, and soft padding makes them comfortable for the dogs to wear. Now the puppies can «walk» like other dogs. Shelter workers say the puppies are now «equipped with front-wheel drive».

The puppies use the carts for about ten minutes at a time. As time (41) _____, they will be able to stay in them longer. When they are not wearing their carts, they get around by hopping on their back legs. Hopping like that can cause stress to their backs, so the carts offer a welcome rest for the puppies' backs.

Venus, Pablo, and Carmen got more than their mobility at the New York shelter. In addition, a worker there (42) _____ all three dogs and given them a good home.

The carts that the three puppies wear were made by a company in Massachusetts. The company was started when its owner built a cart for his own dog. People saw the cart and asked the man to build carts for their pets, too.

	A	B	C	D
38	invention	inventor	inventive	invented
39	get around	getting around	got around	will get around
40	two-wheels	two-wheel	two-wheeled	two-wheeling
41	will pass	pass	passed	passes
42	have adopted	has adopted	adopted	was adopted